RANDSTAD GBS / 2026 EDITION

24 days. A smarter way to work.

Guided Learning

Your activities, examples and space for discoveries.

A LITTLE LEARNING. A LASTING DIFFERENCE.

Use this workbook alongside your approved Google tools. All practice people, records and procedures are fictional. They are not company policy. No company account connection is required.

Documentation checked: 18 October 2026. Exercises are source-checked, not tested in your company tenant. Check current feature availability before live use.

Your 24 discoveries

A step-by-step journey from your first useful prompt to a tested Workspace Studio flow.

Use the practice inputs with the starting prompt. Check the output before using it at work. Keep what helps and return to your notes in January.

01 Clarify a Messy Request / 10 min

02 Understand an Email Thread / 10 min

03 Adapt Writing for the Audience / 10 min

04 Confirm Meeting Actions / 10 min

05 Catch AI Mistakes / 10 min

06 Build a Knowledge Notebook / 15 min

07 Turn Expert Notes Into a Procedure / 15 min

08 Compare Document Versions / 15 min

09 Research With Evidence / 15 min

10 Check Spreadsheet Quality / 15 min

11 Explain Performance Changes / 15 min

12 Identify Finance Exceptions / 15 min

13 Handle Service Requests / 15 min

14 Recruitment Preparation Pack / 15 min

15 Compare Options Transparently / 15 min

16 Communicate a Business Change / 15 min

17 Build a Decision Presentation / 15 min

18 Create a Process Video in Vids / 20 min

19 Build a Reusable Assistant / 15 min

20 Test Reusable Instructions / 15 min

21 First Workspace Studio Flow / 20 min

22 Add Conditional Handling to a Flow / 25 min

23 Create a Practical Handover / 15 min

24 Choose and Measure Lasting Habits / 15 min

DAY 01 / EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

Clarify a Messy Request

Your first habit: agree what good work should look like before generating it.

For: Everyone
Tools: Gemini, Docs / 10 minutes

Before you begin

A company-approved Gemini session. No previous activity is needed.

Try it, step by step

1. Read the sample request and write down what you think the output should be.
2. Ask Gemini to identify ambiguity before it drafts anything.
3. Compare its questions with your own assumptions.
4. Write a revised request that leaves unconfirmed choices visibly open.

Your starting prompt

Help me clarify this task before doing it. List confirmed facts, my likely assumptions and the three questions whose answers would most change the output. Explain why each question matters. Then write a clearer request using only confirmed facts and explicit questions. Do not create the requested work yet.

Paste the practice request.

Practice materials - fictional training only

The unclear work request (TEXT)

From: Alex, Operations
Subject: December service update
Can you put something together about the service changes? We need it before the leadership meeting on 10 December 2026. Use November ticket numbers. It should help the managers explain the change. Priya can check the figures on 8 December. I have not confirmed the audience size or whether this should be slides or an email. Please do not promise an improvement percentage yet.

What good looks like

- Format, audience and approval remain unresolved.
- The revised request is clearer without fabricating missing answers.

Check before you use it

- Compare your initial assumption about slides or email with the source.
- The AI asks useful questions rather than simply rewriting uncertainty.

Something to keep

A task-clarification prompt you can use before any substantial request.

Go further: Answer the three questions with clearly labeled fictional choices and regenerate the brief.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 02 / EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

Understand an Email Thread

Learn to distinguish the latest agreement from earlier proposals.

For: Everyone, Operations, HR, Finance
Tools: Gmail, Gemini / 10 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional thread; no real messages need to be uploaded to this site.

Try it, step by step

1. Read messages from oldest to newest.
2. Ask Gemini for a timeline before requesting any reply.
3. Highlight a superseded date and an unanswered question.
4. Write a two-sentence summary of the current position in your own words.

Your starting prompt

Analyze this thread without drafting a reply. Create a dated timeline of proposals and agreements. Identify the current draft deadline, review date and launch date, including any condition. List unanswered questions and quote the message supporting each current commitment. Mark superseded information.

Paste the practice thread.

Practice materials - fictional training only

An email thread with a changing deadline (TEXT)

2 December, Alex: Please send the draft FAQ by 7 December. We are aiming to launch on 10 December.
3 December, Morgan: The process owner is unavailable until 9 December. Could we move the launch?
4 December, Alex: Agreed. Draft still due 7 December; process-owner review 9 December; launch is now 14 December, subject to review.
4 December, Sam: Who will approve the translation? I can prepare English, but I cannot confirm another language.
No subsequent approval or translation owner is recorded.

What good looks like

- The launch changes from 10 to 14 December, subject to review.
- Sam's translation question is not an acceptance of responsibility.

Check before you use it

- No earlier proposal is reported as the latest decision.
- Quotes match the original messages.

Something to keep

A read-first routine for complex correspondence.

Go further: Now ask for a reply and check that it preserves the timeline.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: collaborate with Gemini in Gmail

https://support.google.com/mail/answer/14355636?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 03 / EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

Adapt Writing for the Audience

Change tone and detail while keeping the facts stable.

For: Everyone, Communications, HR
Tools: Docs, Gmail / 10 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional message with a fixed launch date and requirements.

Try it, step by step

1. List five facts that must survive the rewrite.
2. Generate a colleague message, leadership summary and new-starter explanation.
3. Compare each output against the five facts.
4. Edit one version into language you would actually use.

Your starting prompt

Rewrite the following message for three audiences: a busy colleague, a senior stakeholder and a new starter unfamiliar with the process. Keep the date, required fields, existing-request exception and help contact unchanged. Return each version under 90 words and a shared factual checklist. Do not add benefits or service promises.

Paste the practice writing sample.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A message to improve (TEXT)

As per our previous correspondence, it is incumbent upon all colleagues to ensure that the newly instigated request submission methodology is adhered to with effect from 14 December 2026. Specifically, the requester should supply a business reason and a manager approval reference. Existing requests need not be resubmitted. Questions can be directed to the Service Desk. The purpose is to reduce avoidable follow-up questions.

What good looks like

- Every version retains 14 December and the no-resubmission exception.
- New starters receive clear explanation, not more jargon.

Check before you use it

- Simpler language has not changed a requirement.
- The leadership version does not invent a quantified benefit.

Something to keep

Three audience-aware writing patterns.

Go further: Write a version for a colleague reading English as an additional language, without changing policy meaning.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 04 / EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

Confirm Meeting Actions

Learn what AI may infer when notes leave details unspecified.

For: Everyone, Project Management, Leadership
Tools: Meet, Docs / 10 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional meeting notes. If using Meet, follow your organization's note-taking and sharing settings.

Try it, step by step

1. Mark the words agreed, suggested, open and rejected in the notes.
2. Ask for an action table with evidence for every entry.
3. Correct any invented owner or due date.
4. Draft two clarification questions for the next check-in.

Your starting prompt

Extract actions from these notes. For each give exact evidence, owner and date. Use unconfirmed when the notes do not establish a fact. Place ideas and rejected options outside the action table. Ask two questions needed to make the action list usable.

Paste the meeting notes.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Fictional service review notes (TEXT)

Service review, 7 December 2026
Attendees: Alex (Operations), Priya (Reporting), Sam (Service Desk).
Agreed: pilot a clearer request form with the two existing test teams.
Priya agreed to validate the baseline by 9 December.
Sam suggested a knowledge article; no decision was made.
Alex will draft the form; the group did not agree a due date.
Open: who will approve the pilot?
The pilot cannot start until the baseline and process-owner approval are available.
An early idea to remove the phone channel was rejected.

What good looks like

- Only Priya's baseline action has an explicit 9 December due date.
- The suggested article is not silently assigned to Sam.

Check before you use it

- Every action has supporting words in the notes.
- The rejection of phone-channel removal remains clear.

Something to keep

A habit of confirming actions rather than accepting inferred commitments.

Go further: Compare your own action list with the AI result and discuss differences.

If a feature is unavailable

If meeting notes are unavailable or inappropriate for the meeting, use the fictional notes here or your own permitted notes. Complete the review and action log in Docs.

Official guidance

Google: Take notes for me in Meet

https://support.google.com/meet/answer/14754931?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 05 / EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

Catch AI Mistakes

Practice checking a fluent answer against the evidence.

For: Everyone
Tools: Docs, Gemini / 10 minutes

Before you begin

The planted-error draft, email thread and approved fictional announcement.

Try it, step by step

1. Read the sources before looking at the draft.
2. Underline each factual claim in the draft.
3. Ask Gemini to label claims supported, contradicted or not established.
4. Correct the draft yourself and explain two corrections to a colleague.

Your starting prompt

Audit this draft against the supplied sources. For every factual claim, show the claim, supporting or contradicting evidence and one label: supported, contradicted, not established. Distinguish no evidence from proven false. Then provide a corrected draft under 100 words with no new claims.

Paste the thread, announcement and planted-error draft.

Practice materials - fictional training only

An email thread with a changing deadline (TEXT)

2 December, Alex: Please send the draft FAQ by 7 December. We are aiming to launch on 10 December.
3 December, Morgan: The process owner is unavailable until 9 December. Could we move the launch?
4 December, Alex: Agreed. Draft still due 7 December; process-owner review 9 December; launch is now 14 December, subject to review.
4 December, Sam: Who will approve the translation? I can prepare English, but I cannot confirm another language.
No subsequent approval or translation owner is recorded.

Approved fictional change announcement (TEXT)

TRAINING EXAMPLE - APPROVED FACTS FOR THIS EXERCISE
The new access-request form launches on 14 December 2026.
New requests must include a business reason and manager approval reference, alongside work email and system name.
Existing requests do not need resubmission.
System-owner authorization is still required.
Questions go to the Service Desk.
The change aims to reduce avoidable follow-up questions. No percentage saving or delivery-time promise is approved.

An AI draft with planted mistakes (TEXT)

DRAFT TO CHECK
The new access process launches on 10 December 2026 and will cut resolution time by 40%. Sam will approve translations by 8 December. All existing requests must be resubmitted. Every request will be completed within 24 hours.

Use the email thread and change announcement as the reference. None of the claims above should be accepted without evidence.

What good looks like

- The date and resubmission claims are contradicted.
- The 40% benefit, translation approval and 24-hour promise are not established.

Check before you use it

- A second AI response is still checked against the actual source.
- Corrections remove unsupported claims rather than soften their wording.

Something to keep

A five-part review habit: facts, numbers, sources, commitments and audience.

Go further: Create a new fictional draft with one subtle mistake and ask a colleague to find it.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 06 / EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

Build a Knowledge Notebook

Learn to ask questions that sources can actually answer.

For: Everyone, Learning & Development, IT
Tools: Notebook, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Notebook access or the fallback; current procedure and starter-pack text.

Try it, step by step

1. Create a notebook with two clearly named training sources.
2. Ask one process question, one onboarding question and one question absent from both sources.
3. Inspect citations or the referenced source text and record the gaps.
4. Save a note explaining what this notebook covers and its review date.

Your starting prompt

Using only the selected sources: list the required access-request fields; explain the Day 3 learning task; tell me the exact payroll-access delivery time. For each answer cite its source and separate what is established from what is absent. Finish with a short description of this notebook's scope. Do not fill gaps from general knowledge.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

A fictional team starter pack (TEXT)

TEAM TRAINING EXAMPLE
Day 1: read the Access Request Procedure and ask the buddy to explain one case.
Day 2: practice a service reply on fictional enquiries.
Day 3: check the sample KPI dataset with the supplied definitions.
Day 4: shadow a weekly report review; access must already be authorized.
Day 5: explain the process back to the buddy.
Terms: PO=purchase order; KPI=key performance indicator; service owner=person accountable for a service.
Named buddy, meeting times, and live-system access are not supplied. Do not invent them.

What good looks like

- The first two questions have source support.
- Payroll-access delivery time remains unanswered.

Check before you use it

- Small sources may cite a whole document; still locate the supporting sentence.
- Training rules are never presented as actual company policy.

Something to keep

A small source-based notebook with known limits.

Go further: Have another learner ask a question you did not anticipate.

If a feature is unavailable

If Notebook is unavailable, supply the practice documents directly in an approved Gemini conversation and request source names and quoted evidence. Find and verify every quotation in the originals.

Official guidance

Google: Gemini Notebook help and source answers

https://support.google.com/gemininotebook/answer/16269187?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 07 / WORK WITH EVIDENCE

Turn Expert Notes Into a Procedure

Make tacit knowledge teachable without inventing missing steps.

For: Quality, Operations, IT, Learning & Development
Tools: Docs, Gemini / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional expert notes; no real sign-off or storage location has been agreed.

Try it, step by step

1. Separate known rules from unresolved logistics.
2. Ask for a procedure with inputs, steps, checks and open questions.
3. Walk through it using an imaginary export.
4. Mark the points where a process owner must supply information.

Your starting prompt

Turn these expert notes into a draft procedure for a new colleague. Include purpose, inputs, ordered steps, unique-ticket counting rule, category handling, validation and open questions. Do not invent an approver, storage location or distribution list. Label each unresolved step clearly and preserve the rule for reopened tickets.

Paste the expert notes.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Rough notes from a process expert (TEXT)

For the weekly service report I use the ticket export. Check the reporting dates first; reopened tickets can appear twice. We count unique ticket IDs created that week. Sam has the export. Priya checks the numbers. I normally make a chart of tickets by category. Missing category is Unknown, not Other. We should not email the raw file to everyone. Still need to agree who signs off the final report and where it lives. Someone asked whether reopened tickets count as new; they do not.

What good looks like

- Unique ticket IDs created in the week are counted; reopened tickets are not new.
- Missing categories use Unknown; sign-off and storage remain open.

Check before you use it

- A new colleague can identify the missing decisions.
- The procedure retains the original counting rule.

Something to keep

An expert-review draft with a focused question list.

Go further: Ask a colleague to perform a paper walkthrough and flag ambiguity.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 08 / WORK WITH EVIDENCE

Compare Document Versions

Tell a real process change from a change in wording.

For: Quality, HR, IT, Procurement, Communications
Tools: Notebook, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Both fictional procedure versions, named with their versions and effective dates.

Try it, step by step

1. Read each version's date before comparing the content.
2. Ask for added, removed and unchanged requirements.
3. Trace every change to the relevant source passage.
4. Draft a short impact note for a colleague working after 1 December.

Your starting prompt

Compare Access Request Procedure v1.0 and v2.0. Return a table: topic, old instruction, new instruction, supporting passage, practical impact. Distinguish new wording from new requirements. State which version applies on 10 December 2026. Flag silence in an old source rather than assuming an old exemption.

Paste both versions.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Practice procedure: previous version (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v1.0, effective 1 September 2026.
Requester emails the Service Desk with their work email and system name.
The Service Desk asks the system owner to authorize the access.
Urgent requests are prioritized by the duty lead.
No guidance on contractors or emergency accounts is included.
This version is superseded by v2.0 from 1 December 2026.

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.

No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

What good looks like

- The request form, business reason and approval reference are new explicit requirements.
- System-owner authorization is retained; v2 applies after its effective date.

Check before you use it

- Absence of an old rule is not proof the opposite rule existed.
- The impact note does not invent an SLA.

Something to keep

A source-linked change-impact table.

Go further: Turn the confirmed differences into a three-question FAQ.

If a feature is unavailable

If Notebook is unavailable, supply the practice documents directly in an approved Gemini conversation and request source names and quoted evidence. Find and verify every quotation in the originals.

Official guidance

Google: Gemini Notebook help and source answers

https://support.google.com/gemininotebook/answer/16269187?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 09 / WORK WITH EVIDENCE

Research With Evidence

Practice defining a research question and checking the answer.

For: Everyone, Strategy, Procurement, Recruitment
Tools: Gemini, Notebook / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Approved access to public web sources; optional Deep Research.

Try it, step by step

1. Use the sample task to define a decision-oriented question.
2. Ask for a research plan and correct overly broad scope before starting.
3. Check two primary sources and record dates and limitations.
4. Write a short answer with facts, inferences and open checks separated.

Your starting prompt

Plan research for this question: what should a small business team check before building its first Google Workspace Studio flow? Use official Google documentation only. Focus on starters, variables, notifications, test runs and conditional limitations. Give a plan first, then a brief with direct sources and a verification checklist. Do not claim our tenant has any feature enabled.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Studio test messages (TEXT)

Copy each example into a separate test email sent to your own approved test inbox.
A. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Complete
Body: Requester Alex; audience service managers; deliverable one-page update; deadline 14 December 2026.
B. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Missing details
Body: Please make a service update. Requester Sam.
C. Subject: Lunch plans
Body: Shall we meet at noon?
D. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Conflicting dates
Body: Deadline 14 December. Later note says 16 December, not confirmed. Requester Priya; audience analysts; deliverable FAQ.
Expected: A complete; B needs information; C must not trigger; D requires review. Test runs send actual notifications: use yourself as the recipient.

What good looks like

- The question is narrow enough to answer with a few primary sources.
- The brief distinguishes product documentation from tenant availability.

Check before you use it

- Key advice is supported by an opened official page.
- Testing is described as taking real actions, not a simulation.

Something to keep

A research log with a clear scope and verification record.

Go further: Identify one source statement that might become outdated before December.

If a feature is unavailable

Read the official Studio references here manually. Record their dates, summarize only those pages in Gemini, and verify each summary against the original.

Official guidance

Google: Deep Research

https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/15719111?hl=en

Google: create a Workspace Studio flow

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/16430397

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 10 / WORK WITH EVIDENCE

Check Spreadsheet Quality

Learn to inspect the dataset before asking for insights.

For: Everyone, Reporting, Finance, Operations
Tools: Sheets, Gemini / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Import the fictional ticket CSV. Keep a source tab and a working tab.

Try it, step by step

1. State what one row represents and what makes a ticket unique.
2. Ask for a quality report before any chart or summary.
3. Manually inspect each reported row.
4. Write the limits this data would impose on a management report.

Your starting prompt

Before analyzing this table, describe its apparent grain and the assumptions needed to count tickets or total hours. Check identifiers, duplicates, date formats, missing categories and negative values. Return issue rows and reporting implications. Do not clean automatically, make a chart or total hours until unresolved issues are explained.

Paste the ticket CSV.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A small dataset that needs checking (CSV)

```
row_id,ticket_id,created_date,category,hours
1,T101,2026-11-02,Access,2
2,T102,2026-11-03,access,1.5
3,T102,2026-11-03,Access,1.5
4,,2026-11-04,Hardware,3
5,T104,04/11/2026,,2
6,T105,2026-11-05,Hardware,-1
7,T106,2026-11-06,Software,0
```

What good looks like

- The learner notices record count is not necessarily unique-ticket count.
- Ambiguous dates and duplicate hours affect possible analysis.

Check before you use it

- The report identifies rows, not just generic risks.
- Zero hours is distinguished from missing hours.

Something to keep

A data-readiness note to attach before analysis.

Go further: Explain which questions can still be answered despite the issues.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 11 / WORK WITH EVIDENCE

Explain Performance Changes

Practice percentages, percentage points and evidence-based explanations.

For: Reporting, Leadership, Operations, Finance
Tools: Sheets, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The KPI CSV and definition sheet. Earlier activities are recommended, not required.

Try it, step by step

1. Predict whether a simple mean of team percentages is appropriate.
2. Calculate weekly weighted rates and compare the answer key.
3. Ask Gemini for one headline and three observations.
4. Remove any explanation that is not supported by the data.

Your starting prompt

Analyze these weekly counts using the definition sheet. Explain why team percentages must be weighted by their denominators. Show calculations for created, closed and target attainment, then distinguish relative percent change from percentage-point change. Give one factual headline, three observations and two unanswered why-questions.

Paste data and definitions.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Two weeks of fictional service metrics (CSV)

week,team,tickets_created,tickets_closed,closed_within_target,total_closed_with_target
2026-W47,North,100,90,72,90
2026-W47,South,50,60,54,60
2026-W48,North,120,100,75,100
2026-W48,South,80,70,63,70

Metric definitions and answer key (TEXT)

Fictional reporting rules:
Created and closed are different weekly populations. Do not divide closed-within-target by tickets created.
Target attainment = SUM(closed_within_target) / SUM(total_closed_with_target).
All values are counts for each week, not cumulative totals.
Answer key: W47 created=150, closed=150, attainment=126/150=84%. W48 created=200, closed=170, attainment=138/170=81.1765%.
Created increased 33.33%; closed increased 13.33%; attainment fell about 2.82 percentage points.
No causal evidence, staffing data, backlog baseline, or customer-satisfaction data is supplied. Weekly net flow (created minus closed) is not the total backlog.

What good looks like

- W47 attainment is 126/150, W48 is 138/170.
- A falling attainment rate is reported without claiming a staffing cause.

Check before you use it

- One number has been independently recalculated in Sheets.
- The headline uses the correct units.

Something to keep

A reporting pattern: calculation, observation, limitation, question.

Go further: Show how an unweighted team average would mislead this example.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

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My notes / What I will use again

DAY 12 / WORK WITH EVIDENCE

Identify Finance Exceptions

Translate written rules into a reviewable list of records.

For: Finance, Procurement, Operations
Tools: Sheets, Gemini / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The invoice CSV and practice rules, including the fixed review date.

Try it, step by step

1. Read each rule and predict one example it should catch.
2. Ask for a separate flag column for each rule.
3. Check row 4, a paid invoice, as a deliberate non-exception.
4. Combine flags into a reviewer queue and compare the answer key.

Your starting prompt

Use the training rules to add four proposed flag columns to these fictional rows: duplicate candidate, missing PO, overdue unpaid, negative amount. Explain each flag with row_id and a rule. Review date is 10 December 2026. Include non-flagged rows in the explanation so I can test false positives. Do not make a payment decision.

Paste invoices and rules.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Fictional invoice review (CSV)

```
row_id,vendor,invoice_ref,po_ref,amount_eur,due_date,status
1,Cedar,INV-100,PO-40,1200,2026-12-01,Unpaid
2,Cedar,INV-100,PO-40,1200,2026-12-01,Unpaid
3,Birch,INV-200,,750,2026-12-20,Unpaid
4,Maple,INV-300,PO-42,900,2026-12-02,Paid
5,Maple,INV-301,PO-43,-50,2026-12-03,Unpaid
6,Birch,INV-201,PO-44,600,2026-12-30,Unpaid
```

Practice exception rules (TEXT)

TRAINING RULES ONLY
Review date: 10 December 2026.
Flag repeated vendor + invoice_ref combinations, not the same invoice number at different vendors.
Flag a blank po_ref.
Flag unpaid invoices with due_date before the review date.
Flag negative amounts for review; they may be legitimate credit notes.
Do not block payments, conclude fraud, or remove records.
Answer key: rows 1 and 2 possible duplicate and overdue; row 3 missing PO; row 5 negative amount and overdue; rows 4 and 6 do not trigger these rules.

What good looks like

- The learner verifies both positive flags and unflagged examples.
- Negative amounts prompt a review question rather than an accusation.

Check before you use it

- The duplicate key includes vendor.
- Overdue excludes paid invoices.

Something to keep

A rule-to-test-case pattern useful beyond Finance.

Go further: Create a new invoice that triggers two rules and predict the result first.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 13 / ACROSS THE BUSINESS

Handle Service Requests

Choose between answering, asking for information and referring onward.

For: IT, HR, Finance, Operations
Tools: Gemini, Docs, Gmail / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Current procedure and enquiries A-C. This is a drafting exercise, not a live service action.

Try it, step by step

1. Classify each enquiry yourself before asking Gemini.
2. Generate a source-based handling table and draft replies.
3. Compare your classification with the output and the source.
4. Keep a compact decision tree with exceptions visible.

Your starting prompt

Classify each sample enquiry using this procedure: sufficient information for authorization review, needs clarification, or outside scope. Explain the evidence and draft a helpful reply for each. Do not confuse completeness with approval. If multiple classifications seem possible, explain what a person must resolve.

Paste the procedure and enquiries.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

Three fictional service enquiries (TEXT)

A. I need access to the training reporting system. Work email: alex@example.com. Business reason: weekly reporting. Manager approval reference: M-27.
B. Please give me access to the reporting system urgently.
C. I am a contractor and need emergency payroll access tonight.
Use Access Request Procedure v2.0.
Expected handling: A still needs system-owner authorization; B needs the missing required information; C is outside the procedure and must be referred to the system owner. Urgency is not permission.

What good looks like

- A goes for authorization, B needs information, C is outside scope.

- No response promises access or a service time.

Check before you use it

- The decision tree preserves the same scope as the procedure.

- Urgency does not become an authorization shortcut.

Something to keep

A service-handling decision tree and three response patterns.

Go further: Test a fourth enquiry with all fields but a conflicting system name.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: collaborate with Gemini in Gmail

https://support.google.com/mail/answer/14355636?hl=en

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 14 / ACROSS THE BUSINESS

Recruitment Preparation Pack

Explore a specialist use case while preserving human judgment.

For: Recruitment, HR, Leadership
Tools: Docs, Gemini / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional analyst role; no candidate personal data is required.

Try it, step by step

1. Extract the role's outcomes and competency requirements.
2. Ask for intake clarifications, interview questions and evidence fields.
3. Remove unsupported credentials and subjective trait labels.
4. Ask a human interviewer to review whether each question is job-relevant.

Your starting prompt

Create a compact preparation pack from this role: a five-line brief, three intake questions, one interview question per competency and blank evidence fields. Show which requirement each question tests. Do not evaluate a candidate, add screening thresholds or infer protected or personal characteristics.

Paste the role.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Fictional role and competencies (TEXT)

Role: Service Operations Analyst.
Purpose: produce reliable weekly reporting and improve service request quality.
Outcomes: maintain an agreed KPI glossary; prepare a checked weekly report; document two recurring data issues.
Required competencies: spreadsheet analysis, structured problem solving, stakeholder communication.
Interview evidence: candidate explains a calculation check; distinguishes symptoms from causes; describes how they clarified an ambiguous request.
No degree, age, nationality, specific employer history, or years-of-experience threshold is required in this training example.
Hiring decisions remain with human interviewers.

What good looks like

- The pack includes reporting, problem solving and stakeholder communication.
- Unspecified hiring criteria remain questions.

Check before you use it

- Questions map to the actual role rather than generic preferences.
- The output supports human interviewers without ranking people.

Something to keep

A job-relevant preparation pack that demonstrates responsible task support.

Go further: Adapt the pack to a different fictional role and compare required inputs.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 15 / ACROSS THE BUSINESS

Compare Options Transparently

Learn to compare evidence without hiding uncertainty inside a score.

For: Procurement, Finance, IT, Project Management
Tools: Sheets, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The option CSV and predefined criteria.

Try it, step by step

1. List must-have requirements before looking at prices.
2. Ask for an evidence matrix and a gap list.
3. Check costs and user counts yourself.
4. Write a conditional recommendation that names what must be clarified.

Your starting prompt

Build an evidence matrix from the proposals and criteria. Use meets, does not meet or unknown for each requirement, with the supplied evidence. Show known first-year costs without converting missing values to zero. Explain what additional information is needed before a human selects an option. Do not invent scores or weights.

Paste options and criteria.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Three fictional service-tool proposals (CSV)

option,annual_price_eur,setup_eur,training_hours,included_users,support,export_available
Cedar,12000,2000,8,50,Weekdays,Yes
Birch,10000,4000,12,40,Weekdays,Yes
Maple,15000,,6,50,24 hours,Unknown

Decision criteria for a practice purchase (TEXT)

Training decision: compare three service tools for 50 users.
Required: export capability, at least 50 included users, and weekday support.
Budget: EUR 16,000 first year, including setup. Additional user prices are not supplied.
Do not score missing information as zero or assume it meets the requirement.
First-year known cost = annual price + setup; internal training time is reported separately.
Decision owner: fictional project sponsor. No vendor has been selected.

What good looks like

- Birch does not meet the known 50-user requirement without further pricing.
- Maple cost/export questions stay unknown.

Check before you use it

- Weights are not created after seeing which option they favor.
- Known price and full comparable cost are distinguished.

Something to keep

An options matrix that a reviewer can challenge.

Go further: Create a sensitivity question about setup cost without assuming its answer.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 16 / ACROSS THE BUSINESS

Communicate a Business Change

Make the same approved facts useful to different audiences.

For: Communications, HR, Operations, Leadership
Tools: Docs, Gmail, Slides / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The approved fictional change announcement; no creative-media tool is needed.

Try it, step by step

1. Create a factual source checklist from the announcement.
2. Generate an employee email, manager talking points and a FAQ.
3. Check consistency across all three formats.
4. Ask a colleague to identify the action they should take and when.

Your starting prompt

Adapt this announcement into an employee email under 120 words, four manager talking points and a five-question FAQ. Preserve the date, required fields, existing-request exception and authorization rule. Explain the purpose without inventing a percentage improvement. Keep an unanswered-question section where facts are missing.

Paste the announcement.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Approved fictional change announcement (TEXT)

TRAINING EXAMPLE - APPROVED FACTS FOR THIS EXERCISE
The new access-request form launches on 14 December 2026.
New requests must include a business reason and manager approval reference, alongside work email and system name.
Existing requests do not need resubmission.
System-owner authorization is still required.
Questions go to the Service Desk.
The change aims to reduce avoidable follow-up questions. No percentage saving or delivery-time promise is approved.

What good looks like

- Every format says 14 December and no resubmission of existing requests.
- Readers can tell what changes and what remains required.

Check before you use it

- One output has not quietly introduced a stronger promise.
- The FAQ does not fill policy gaps from general knowledge.

Something to keep

A coordinated change-communication pack.

Go further: Create a single-slide reminder with the same factual checklist.

If a feature is unavailable

If the Gemini side panel is unavailable, use the approved Gemini app with this fictional practice text, or complete the same steps manually in a Doc. No connection to this learning site is required.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Google: collaborate with Gemini in Gmail

https://support.google.com/mail/answer/14355636?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 17 / ACROSS THE BUSINESS

Build a Decision Presentation

Practice turning evidence into a concise recommendation.

For: Leadership, Project Management, Operations, Finance
Tools: Slides, Docs, Sheets / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The checked report and a blank or approved Slides template.

Try it, step by step

1. Write the decision you want the audience to make.
2. Ask for a slide story with evidence and caveats.
3. Create an editable draft in Slides and inspect every number.
4. Practice a two-minute explanation ending with the actual decision request.

Your starting prompt

Create a five-slide story for a manager deciding whether to permit the proposed request-form pilot. Use: decision context, checked evidence, evidence limits, pilot design questions, decision request. Give headlines, concise content and speaker notes. Use only the supplied report; do not present the pilot owner or benefit as approved.

Paste the report.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A checked fictional weekly report (TEXT)

SERVICE REPORT - TRAINING EXAMPLE
W47: 150 tickets created, 150 closed; target attainment 84%.
W48: 200 created, 170 closed; target attainment 81.18%.
Created volume rose 33.33%; closed volume rose 13.33%; attainment fell 2.82 percentage points.
No staffing or customer-satisfaction data supplied; do not claim why attainment fell.
Known issue: 18 W48 category values need validation.
Decision requested: permit a two-week request-form pilot while preserving existing authorization.
Pilot owner proposed: Alex, subject to sponsor agreement.
No budget or benefit percentage has been approved.

What good looks like

- The story separates a proposed action from observed performance.
- A reader can locate the source behind each quantitative claim.

Check before you use it

- The evidence-gap slide is not removed to make the case look stronger.
- Charts do not introduce new categories or invented data.

Something to keep

An evidence-to-decision presentation pattern.

Go further: Ask a colleague to challenge one recommendation using the same source.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: creating across Workspace apps

https://workspace.google.com/blog/product-announcements/less-switching-more-flow-5-new-agentic-capabilities-across-google-workspace-apps

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 18 / ACROSS THE BUSINESS

Create a Process Video in Vids

Turn a checked process into a short learning experience.

For: Learning & Development, IT, HR, Communications
Tools: Vids, Docs / 20 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional procedure. Use Vids where enabled or the storyboard fallback.

Try it, step by step

1. Choose one learner outcome: submit a complete access request.
2. Draft a six-scene storyboard using the prompt.
3. Use Vids Help me create with the source Doc where available, then edit each scene.
4. Watch the result with sound off and check readable text, captions and source accuracy.

Your starting prompt

Storyboard a 90-second video teaching a new starter to submit a complete access request. For each scene give duration, narration, on-screen text and a simple visual. Total duration must be 90 seconds. Include system-owner authorization and the outside-scope referral. Avoid real employee imagery and invented portal links.

Use the practice procedure.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

What good looks like

- Scene durations total 90 seconds.
- The learner sees the four required inputs and the authorization step.

Check before you use it

- Text remains readable long enough to understand.
- Narration and captions agree and do not add promises.

Something to keep

A reviewed storyboard and, where enabled, an editable Vids draft.

Go further: Ask someone unfamiliar with the process to explain the required action after watching.

If a feature is unavailable

If Vids or an AI video feature is unavailable, create the storyboard and narration in Docs, then build the same scenes in Slides. A checked script is a valid takeaway.

Official guidance

Google: create a first video in Vids

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/14819770?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 19 / REUSE & AUTOMATE

Build a Reusable Assistant

Turn one good interaction into instructions you can use again.

For: Everyone, Quality, IT, HR
Tools: Gems / Skills, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The assistant specification and current procedure. Access varies during the Gems/Skills transition.

Try it, step by step

1. Choose the narrow service-reply task rather than an all-purpose assistant.
2. Write instructions covering inputs, evidence, output and stop conditions.
3. Save them in the available Gems/Skills interface or a versioned Doc.
4. Start a fresh interaction with enquiry A and inspect the result.

Your starting prompt

Write reusable instructions for the assistant specification below. Ask for a current procedure and an enquiry if either is missing. Base facts only on that procedure. Structure output as facts, gaps, draft response, source and review questions. Stop for contradictory guidance or cases outside scope. Never send a message, grant access or promise a service time.

Paste the specification.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Reusable assistant specification (TEXT)

Assistant name: Service Reply Drafting Helper.
Task: prepare draft replies to access enquiries using the supplied procedure.
Required inputs: enquiry and current procedure with version/date.
Output: case summary; facts; missing information; draft reply; source section; human review questions.
Limits: never grant access, invent a completion date, change authorization, or infer permission from urgency.
If the procedure is missing or contradictory, ask for clarification before drafting advice.
Training references: Access Request Procedure v2.0 and Three fictional service enquiries.

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the

system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

Three fictional service enquiries (TEXT)

A. I need access to the training reporting system. Work email: alex@example.com. Business reason: weekly reporting. Manager approval reference: M-27.
B. Please give me access to the reporting system urgently.
C. I am a contractor and need emergency payroll access tonight.
Use Access Request Procedure v2.0.
Expected handling: A still needs system-owner authorization; B needs the missing required information; C is outside the procedure and must be referred to the system owner. Urgency is not permission.

What good looks like

- The saved instructions work in a fresh interaction with supplied references.
- The assistant requests missing sources rather than inventing them.

Check before you use it

- The task has a clear boundary and named human reviewer.
- Source-file sharing follows existing permissions if the configuration is shared.

Something to keep

A small reusable assistant with explicit limits.

Go further: Explain the difference between saved instructions and a flow that runs on an event.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gems or Skills is unavailable during the rollout, save the complete instructions in a Doc and paste them at the start of a fresh Gemini conversation. Test the same cases; do not assume instructions transfer between apps.

Official guidance

Google: Gems to Skills transition and rollout updates

https://workspaceupdates.googleblog.com/2026/09/skills-gemini-app-workspace.html?hl=en_UG

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 20 / REUSE & AUTOMATE

Test Reusable Instructions

A saved prompt is a draft until you test how it handles difficult inputs.

For: Everyone, Quality, Leadership
Tools: Gems / Skills, Docs / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The saved Day 19 instructions, or the specification below; a blank test log.

Try it, step by step

1. Write expected behavior before each test.
2. Run a complete request, an incomplete request and a request outside scope.
3. Add a fourth test with conflicting procedure versions and compare outputs.
4. Revise one instruction, rerun the failed case and record the version change.

Your starting prompt

Help me evaluate this service assistant, not just praise it. Create a test table with case, input sources, expected behavior, actual result, pass/fail and revision needed. Include complete, incomplete, outside-scope and contradictory-source cases. Judge only observable behavior and source use. Leave actual-result fields blank until I run each case.

Paste the assistant specification and sample enquiries.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Reusable assistant specification (TEXT)

Assistant name: Service Reply Drafting Helper.
Task: prepare draft replies to access enquiries using the supplied procedure.
Required inputs: enquiry and current procedure with version/date.
Output: case summary; facts; missing information; draft reply; source section; human review questions.
Limits: never grant access, invent a completion date, change authorization, or infer permission from urgency.
If the procedure is missing or contradictory, ask for clarification before drafting advice.
Training references: Access Request Procedure v2.0 and Three fictional service enquiries.

Three fictional service enquiries (TEXT)

A. I need access to the training reporting system. Work email: alex@example.com. Business reason: weekly reporting. Manager approval reference: M-27.
B. Please give me access to the reporting system urgently.
C. I am a contractor and need emergency payroll access tonight.
Use Access Request Procedure v2.0.
Expected handling: A still needs system-owner authorization; B needs the missing required information; C is outside the procedure and must be referred to the system owner. Urgency is not permission.

Practice procedure: access requests (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v2.0, effective 1 December 2026. Owner: fictional Service Desk.
1. The requester provides their work email, system name, business reason, and manager approval reference in the request form.
2. The Service Desk checks completeness. Missing information is returned to the requester; no completion date is promised.
3. A complete request goes to the system owner to authorize the specific access.
4. The Service Desk records the decision and, if authorized, arranges access.
5. Urgent requests follow the same authorization steps; the duty lead decides priority.
6. This procedure does not cover contractor access, payroll access, or emergency accounts. Refer these cases to the system owner.
No standard delivery time or automatic authorization is specified.

Practice procedure: previous version (TEXT)

TRAINING DOCUMENT - NOT A RANDSTAD POLICY
Access Request Procedure v1.0, effective 1 September 2026.
Requester emails the Service Desk with their work email and system name.
The Service Desk asks the system owner to authorize the access.
Urgent requests are prioritized by the duty lead.
No guidance on contractors or emergency accounts is included.
This version is superseded by v2.0 from 1 December 2026.

What good looks like

- An incomplete case produces questions; an outside-scope case refers onward.

- Old and current versions are distinguished; unresolved contradictions trigger clarification.

Check before you use it

- Actual results come from runs rather than AI predictions.

- A revised prompt is retested on a previously passing case too.

Something to keep

A versioned assistant and a small regression test log.

Go further: Ask a colleague to add one test you did not anticipate.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gems or Skills is unavailable during the rollout, save the complete instructions in a Doc and paste them at the start of a fresh Gemini conversation. Test the same cases; do not assume instructions transfer between apps.

Official guidance

Google: Gems to Skills transition and rollout updates

https://workspaceupdates.googleblog.com/2026/09/skills-gemini-app-workspace.html?hl=en_UG

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 21 / REUSE & AUTOMATE

First Workspace Studio Flow

Connect an email event to a useful personal notification.

For: Everyone, Operations, IT, HR
Tools: Workspace Studio, Gmail / 20 minutes

Before you begin

Studio access, Gemini steps and your own permitted test inbox. Test runs perform real actions.

Try it, step by step

1. In Studio create a flow from the prompt and review the generated starter.

2. Restrict the Gmail starter to subjects containing TRAINING-REQUEST; add Ask Gemini with starter variables for subject and body.

3. Send the extracted summary through a Chat notification to yourself only; include the source reference when available.

4. Test A and B and verify C never starts the flow. Inspect the run history and switch off the practice flow afterward.

Your starting prompt

Create a training flow that starts only for new Gmail messages whose subjects contain TRAINING-REQUEST. Ask Gemini to summarize the request and list requester, audience, deliverable and deadline from the starter message variables. Mark missing or conflicting fields. Send the brief to me in Google Chat with the email reference. Do not email the sender or take further action.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Studio test messages (TEXT)

Copy each example into a separate test email sent to your own approved test inbox.
A. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Complete
Body: Requester Alex; audience service managers; deliverable one-page update; deadline 14 December 2026.
B. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Missing details
Body: Please make a service update. Requester Sam.
C. Subject: Lunch plans
Body: Shall we meet at noon?
D. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Conflicting dates
Body: Deadline 14 December. Later note says 16 December, not confirmed. Requester Priya; audience analysts; deliverable FAQ.
Expected: A complete; B needs information; C must not trigger; D requires review. Test runs send actual notifications: use yourself as the recipient.

What good looks like

- A notification contains actual message fields, not the sample prompt text.

- B retains missing information; C is ignored.

Check before you use it

- Starter variables are inserted through the picker.
- The test recipient is yourself and no reply step was generated.

Something to keep

A simple tested event-to-notification flow.

Go further: Document the owner and how to turn off or troubleshoot the flow.

If a feature is unavailable

If Studio or an AI step is unavailable, paste each test message into Gemini, apply the same extraction and routing rules, and record the expected notification in a Doc. This teaches the workflow without enabling automation.

Official guidance

Google: create a Workspace Studio flow

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/16430397

Google: Studio starters, steps and variables

https://support.google.com/workspace-studio/table/17176961?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 22 / REUSE & AUTOMATE

Add Conditional Handling to a Flow

Choose the right notification when information is incomplete.

For: Operations, HR, IT, Finance
Tools: Workspace Studio, Gmail / 25 minutes

Before you begin

A copy of Day 21's flow, or rebuild the described starter and extraction. Use only personal test notifications.

Try it, step by step

1. Keep extraction at the top level. Add Decide to check completeness and unambiguous dates using those variables.

2. Review its paired Check if for true and put a Ready for review notification inside that branch.

3. Add a separate Check if for the same decision being false, with a Needs clarification notification inside it. Do not nest conditions.

4. Run A, B and D; compare expected routing and count notifications. Test C for exclusion and turn off the training flow.

Your starting prompt

Add conditional handling to my training request flow. Decide whether requester, audience, deliverable and one unambiguous deadline are present. Check if true: notify me Ready for review with top-level extracted fields. Separate Check if false: notify me Needs clarification with missing or conflicting information. Keep notifications within their branches and never treat readiness as authorization. Do not add nested conditions or send external messages.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Studio test messages (TEXT)

Copy each example into a separate test email sent to your own approved test inbox.
A. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Complete
Body: Requester Alex; audience service managers; deliverable one-page update; deadline 14 December 2026.
B. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Missing details
Body: Please make a service update. Requester Sam.
C. Subject: Lunch plans
Body: Shall we meet at noon?
D. Subject: TRAINING-REQUEST Conflicting dates
Body: Deadline 14 December. Later note says 16 December, not confirmed. Requester Priya; audience analysts; deliverable FAQ.
Expected: A complete; B needs information; C must not trigger; D requires review. Test runs send actual notifications: use yourself as the recipient.

What good looks like

- A gets one Ready for review notification.

- B and D each get one Needs clarification notification; C gets none.

Check before you use it

- No top-level action reads a variable created only in a branch.
- Both true and false cases have been observed in real test runs.

Something to keep

A conditional flow and a route-by-route test record.

Go further: Write a recovery note for unexpected input or a failed notification step.

If a feature is unavailable

If Studio or an AI step is unavailable, paste each test message into Gemini, apply the same extraction and routing rules, and record the expected notification in a Doc. This teaches the workflow without enabling automation.

Official guidance

Google: conditional steps in Studio

https://support.google.com/workspace-studio/answer/16431010?hl=en

Google: Studio starters, steps and variables

https://support.google.com/workspace-studio/table/17176961?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 23 / REUSE & AUTOMATE

Create a Practical Handover

Make it possible for another person to continue the work.

For: Everyone, Project Management, Operations
Tools: Docs, Notebook / 15 minutes

Before you begin

The fictional holiday notes; no real report link or backup approver is supplied.

Try it, step by step

1. Separate status, next actions, dependencies and authority.
2. Generate a handover with open questions and source links where known.
3. Ask a colleague to answer who can approve and when the report is due.
4. Revise gaps discovered in that walkthrough; never fabricate a missing link.

Your starting prompt

Create a holiday handover from these notes. Include current work, confirmed deadlines, proposed dates, dependencies, coverage, decision authority, source links and unresolved gaps. Mark missing links as not supplied, not a fabricated URL. Add five questions a cover colleague should be able to answer.

Paste the handover notes.

Practice materials - fictional training only

Fictional holiday handover notes (TEXT)

Alex is away 21-28 December 2026.
Form pilot: draft ready; sponsor approval still pending. Proposed start 4 January 2027, not committed.
Priya will validate the final baseline by 18 December.
Sam covers service queries; authority to approve changes has not been assigned.
Next reporting deadline: 22 December, 12:00. Checked report location: link not supplied.
Open: sponsor decision, backup approver, report link.
Escalation: duty lead for priority; system owner for authorization.
Do not treat proposed start dates or unassigned authority as confirmed.

What good looks like

- 22 December noon is the report deadline; 4 January is only a proposed pilot start.
- Sam's cover role does not imply change-approval authority.

Check before you use it

- An absent source link stays visibly unresolved.
- The reader can identify the actual escalation roles.

Something to keep

A handover verified by someone who would use it.

Go further: Build a small notebook from the handover and sources, then test its answers.

If a feature is unavailable

If Notebook is unavailable, supply the practice documents directly in an approved Gemini conversation and request source names and quoted evidence. Find and verify every quotation in the originals.

Official guidance

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Google: Gemini Notebook help and source answers

https://support.google.com/gemininotebook/answer/16269187?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again

DAY 24 / REUSE & AUTOMATE

Choose and Measure Lasting Habits

Finish with a small plan you can sustain in January.

For: Everyone, Leadership
Tools: Docs, Sheets / 15 minutes

Before you begin

Your own activity notes or the fictional log. A sample result is not a measured company benefit.

Try it, step by step

1. List one habit, one reusable instruction set and one optional automation worth retaining.
2. Calculate net time including review, then note setup and maintenance separately.
3. Discuss quality changes, errors caught and tasks where AI was not helpful.
4. Schedule a January review and name what evidence would justify keeping each method.

Your starting prompt

Review this activity log. Calculate baseline minus drafting minus review time per run, keeping sample and personal evidence separate. Do not fill missing data or convert time into cash savings. Recommend at most three habits with a quality check, setup/maintenance note, owner and 30-day review question. Include one reason to stop or redesign each habit.

Paste the labeled activity log.

Practice materials - fictional training only

A fictional activity and benefits log (CSV)

```
workflow,baseline_min,ai_draft_min,review_min,runs,quality_check
Email brief,12,3,4,3,All facts checked
KPI update,25,8,12,2,One denominator corrected
Studio notification,5,0,1,4,One unrelated trigger fixed
Video guide,,,,0,Not tested
```

What good looks like

- Sample net time savings are 5, 5 and 4 minutes per run; video is untested.
- The plan acknowledges corrections and the limited number of observations.

Check before you use it

- Self-reported results do not become a maturity score or company ROI.
- Every retained habit has a practical quality test.

Something to keep

A three-habit January plan with a review date and evidence needs.

Go further: Agree with your manager which one team workflow to maintain and who will review it.

If a feature is unavailable

If Gemini in Sheets is unavailable, paste the fictional CSV and task into approved Gemini, then reproduce and check its calculations in Sheets using formulas. Keep the original data intact.

Official guidance

Google: analyze data in Sheets

https://support.google.com/a/users/answer/9283139?hl=en

Google: writing with Gemini in Docs

https://support.google.com/docs/answer/13447609?hl=en

Documentation checked 2026-10-18. Feature access varies. This exercise has not been run in your company tenant.

My notes / What I will use again